Catfish King Operational Portal BOARD SUMMARY

Replacing DataCache with an owned system for 11 restaurant locations

Prepared for: Clay Conditt, EVP · Prepared by: Joel Escoto, Piney Digital · July 6, 2026

5-Year Cost of Ownership (You Own Every Account)

Year	Build Cost	To Providers (VPS, storage, email)	To Piney Digital (support retainer)	Annual Total
Year 1 Phases 1–4 + 1 free month	$20,000	$600 $50/mo × 12	$0 free during build + 1 month	**$20,600**
Year 2	—	$600	$1,650 $150 × 11 (after 1 free mo)	**$2,250**
Year 3	—	$600	$1,800 $150 × 12	**$2,400**
Year 4	—	$720 storage growth	$1,800	**$2,520**
Year 5	—	$720	$1,800	**$2,520**
5-YEAR TOTAL				**$30,290**

Phase 1 (pilot, 1–2 stores) is $9,500 to start and can be validated before committing to the remaining $10,500 (Phases 2–4). The 1-month free support starts after Phase 4 is delivered. $150/month begins month 2.

What's Included — $200/month Total After Stabilization

Line Item	Who Pays	Monthly	Annual	What It Is
Server (DigitalOcean VPS)	You → DO	$24	$288	The "computer" the portal runs on
Database (PostgreSQL on VPS)	You → provider	$0	$0	The "filing cabinet" for sales, inventory, schedules
File & document storage (Backblaze B2)	You → B2	$20	$240	PDFs, schedules, photos, invoices (≈300 GB at Year 5)
Backups (offsite, 30-day)	You → B2	(incl.)	(incl.)	Nightly snapshots, recoverable anytime
Email notifications (Postmark/SES)	You → provider	$5	$60	Password resets, submission confirmations
Domain registration	You → registrar	~$1	$15	The address (portal.greatamericanfoods.com)
Piney Digital support retainer	You → me	**$150**	**$1,800**	Bug fixes, small UI changes, security, login help, server admin
TOTAL		**$200**	**$2,400**	**Predictable. No per-user fees. No per-report fees.**

How the timing works: $20,000 build over 12 weeks. 1 free month of support after delivery (onboarding, training, settling in). $150/month starts the month after that. Cancel anytime with 30 days notice.

What You Own at Completion

✓ Included — Always Yours

- ✓ All source code for the portal
- ✓ All data & uploaded documents
- ✓ Database schema, design, backups
- ✓ Documentation & user guides
- ✓ Hosting account credentials
- ✓ Domain registration & admin access
- ✓ Data export anytime, no fees, no permission

— Not Included (Optional Adds)

- — 24/7 after-hours incident response (+$200/mo)
- — New feature development (quoted per change)
- — Mobile native apps (separate quote)
- — Payroll/accounting integration
- — POS hardware integration

What Happens If You Want to Leave Piney Digital

You can walk away with everything on day one. Standard technology (Python Flask, SQLite/PostgreSQL, HTML). Any developer can run it. Typical migration to another host or developer: **$2,000–$5,000**. No lock-in. No proprietary formats.

Return on Investment

Scenario	Annual Cost	Notes
Current (DataCache + paper)	**$35,000 – $50,000**	Paper, ink, manager hours, DataCache fees
New system (Year 1)	**$20,600**	$20k build + $600 to providers + $0 support (free)
New system (Year 2 onward)	**~$2,400/year**	**Flat. $600 providers + $1,800 support retainer.**
Annual savings (Year 2+)	**$32,000 – $47,000**	5-year savings: $155,000 – $235,000

> **Payback period: ~7 months.** Pays for itself in Year 1, saves $30,000+/year after. 5-year TCO: $30,290 vs. $175,000–$250,000 staying on the current path.

The Bottom Line for the Board

- **$20,000 one-time build, ~$2,400/year to operate** — replaces a $35k–$50k/year paper problem
- **You own every account** — VPS, database, storage, email, domain, code, GitHub repo
- **1 free month of support after delivery** — onboarding, training, settling in
- **$150/month flat support** after that — bug fixes, small changes, security, server admin
- **No lock-in** — move to another developer or host anytime for $2,000–$5,000
- **No markup on infrastructure** — you pay DigitalOcean what DigitalOcean charges
- **Predictable costs** — fixed-price phases, no per-user fees, no surprise invoices
- **Pilot option** — start with $9,500 Phase 1, validate, then proceed

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Detailed 5-year breakdown, scope of work, and full legal terms in: **SOW_Catfish_King_FINAL.md** · Questions: joel@pineydigital.com